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erators to acquire real-time data, such as a vehicle's location, route or fuel level. They can use that information to optimise the costs of the vehicle and its load factor.

How can the designer ensure that he does not get noticed for the wrong reason—like an in-secure product (this seems to be the biggest plague in IoT)?

Security issue is addressed by performing threat analysis, which usually focusses on the following three points:

1. Where (client/server/database/RAM/etc) is the safety-relevant data located?
2. Which are the possible security threats?
3. Identifying where the security risks exist and coming up with the probability of an exploit of an identified vulnerability.

One approach for safe and ethical use can be to have an IoT architecture that follows a standardised approach across industries—the Semantic Web was one approach, but security issues have to be resolved.

Which protocol would you advice our design engineers to work with for sensitive applications—IPv4 or IPv6?

IPv6 offers better security and control capabilities compared to IPv4, but IPv6 security has not been 'field proven.' Testing has revealed vulnerabilities. Therefore, in short term, deploying applications using IPv6 represents a higher security risk than deploying them using IPv4, but since every device has its own unique Internet address and avoids administrative traffic, the recommendation by experts is for IPv6.

We have known about data security and viruses on IT systems. Lot of work is now going on to improve data security in embedded systems, which is key for widespread use of IoT.

What are some interesting real-world examples of IoT in industrial settings?

The next industrial revolution 4.0 setup will pave the way to a complex technological revolution that will drastically change the entire value chain. Let us take an example. Components will only be manufactured in real time and in response to concrete orders. The components themselves will bear all information on technical requirements, customers and destination, allowing them to control the production process autonomously. This means that the individual component will know exactly which production steps are to be carried out, which parts may still be missing and which destination it has to select in order to ultimately meet all customer-specific requirements. Customers will be able to obtain information on the real-time status of the order at all times.

Another example is predictive maintenance, now featured in a newly-launched product from Bosch. Here, sensors record the condition of machinery and software identifies problematic patterns in order to predict possible issues. This helps prevent costly production stoppages and allows maintenance to be performed at optimum times. ●